

Bubbles and the quest for the shimmering leaf

Underwater travel story • 3-4 years old



Chapter 1: Bubbles and the Big Blue

Bubbles was a little yellow seahorse. She lived in the soft, wavy sea grass at the bottom of the ocean. Her tail curled just right, and she loved to play hide-and-seek with the tiny fish. Every morning, Bubbles watched the sunbeams dance on the water. The ocean was her home, and she felt safe and happy.

One bright morning, Bubbles saw something strange. The water was not as sparkly. The sea grass was a little droopy. Bubbles remembered what wise Old Turtle had told her: « **If the water is not clear, look for the Shimmering Leaf. It will help the ocean feel better.** »

Bubbles took a deep breath. She wanted to help her home. She wiggled her tail. "I can do it," she said softly.

Bubbles set off on her adventure. She swam past wiggly worms and sleepy starfish. The path was twisty, but Bubbles did not rush. She looked carefully all around, peeking behind every shell.

Chapter 2: Friends Along the Way

Soon, Bubbles met a friendly octopus named Inky. Inky had eight long arms and a big, happy smile. "Hello, Bubbles! Where are you going?" Inky asked.

"I am looking for the Shimmering Leaf," said Bubbles. "It can make the water clean again."

"I will help you," Inky said.

Together, they swam past a field of jiggly jellyfish. The jellyfish glowed soft pink and blue. They waved as Bubbles and Inky passed by.

Suddenly, a big shell blocked the way. Bubbles tried to move it, but it was too heavy. Inky wrapped his arms around the shell and gently pushed. With a little teamwork, the shell rolled away.

“Thank you, Inky!” Bubbles cheered.

“You’re welcome,” Inky said with a giggle.

They swam deeper into the blue. Bubbles saw a bright light ahead. It was Glimmer, the glowing fish. She shimmered in gold and green.

“Hello, Bubbles and Inky!” said Glimmer. “Why are you here?”

“We are looking for the Shimmering Leaf,” said Bubbles.

“I saw something shiny near the coral cave,” Glimmer said. “I will show you the way.”

Chapter 3: The Shimmering Leaf

Bubbles, Inky, and Glimmer went to the coral cave. The cave was full of colors—red, orange, blue, and purple. Little crabs clicked their claws, but they smiled when they saw Bubbles.

They searched for the Shimmering Leaf. Bubbles looked under a rock. Inky peeked behind a sponge. Glimmer shined her light on the cave walls.

Bubbles did not find the leaf at first. She took a deep breath and waited. She watched tiny bubbles float up. She remembered what Old Turtle had said: “Sometimes, you need to wait and look carefully.”

Bubbles peered closely at a patch of seaweed. There, hidden in the green, was a leaf that glowed silver and white. It sparkled in the dim light.

"I found it!" Bubbles called.

Her friends swam over. The Shimmering Leaf was soft and bright. Bubbles took it gently with her tail.

"Now, we can help the sea," said Bubbles.

They swam back together. Bubbles placed the leaf on the sea grass. A gentle light spread through the water. The grass perked up. The water turned clear and bright. Fish swam happily. The ocean sparkled again.

"Thank you, Bubbles!" the sea creatures cheered.

Bubbles smiled. She felt proud and happy.

"We did it together," said Bubbles.

"Yes," said Inky. "We are a good team."

Bubbles curled her tail and floated gently. The adventure was over. She was home. The water was clear, and her heart was calm.

She closed her eyes and listened to the soft waves. Bubbles knew she could be patient. She knew she was brave. And she knew, with friends, she could do anything.

The ocean was full of wonder. And Bubbles was ready for new adventures, tomorrow.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What is Bubbles?

- A fish
- A seahorse
- A crab
- A turtle

2) What did Bubbles want to find?

- A treasure chest
- The Shimmering Leaf
- A magic wand
- A big shell

3) Who helped Bubbles on her adventure?

- A dolphin
- An octopus and a fish
- A starfish
- A sea turtle

4) What happened when they found the Shimmering Leaf?

- The ocean became messy
- The water turned clear and bright
- They found a new friend
- They went to sleep

Correct answers:

1) A seahorse 2) The Shimmering Leaf 3) An octopus and a fish 4) The water turned clear and bright

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Seahorse: A small marine fish with a horse-like head, known for its unique shape.

Shimmering: Glowing or shining with a soft light.

Adventure: An exciting experience or journey, often involving exploration.

Teamwork: Working together with others to achieve a common goal.

Coral: A hard substance made of tiny sea creatures, often forming reefs in the ocean.

Sparkling: Shining brightly with many small flashes of light.